

IC substrates drive growth; PCB margins lag

Maintain Buy; raise TP to CNY39, implying 17.3% upside

Revenue in line; gross margin recovery lagged our expectations

The company reported 1H26 results after market close on 20 August. Revenue rose 17.9% y-y to CNY4.04bn, gross margin expanded 2.5pp y-y to 20.95%, and net profit increased 283.3% y-y to CNY110mn. In 2Q26, revenue reached CNY2.22bn, up 20.2% y-y and 22.1% q-q, while net profit rose 371.5% y-y and 389.5% q-q to CNY92mn. 1H26 revenue was broadly in line with our forecast, while net profit missed our expectations, mainly due to a slower-than-expected recovery in gross margin.

IC substrates drive growth; PCB margins under pressure

In 1H26, IC package substrate revenue rose 67.3% y-y to CNY1.21bn, accounting for 29.9% of total revenue. Gross margin improved 24.81pp y-y to -0.36%, ahead of our expectations, which we attribute mainly to rapid growth in CSP substrate sales amid robust memory demand, as well as price increases that helped pass on cost pressures. By contrast, traditional PCB revenue rose only 2.2% y-y, while gross margin declined 0.8pp to 25.6%, below our expectations, mainly due to weaker-than-expected revenue growth at the subsidiary Yixing Silicon Valley Electronics and higher raw-material costs. Semiconductor test board revenue increased 10.5% y-y to CNY120mn, while gross margin fell 15.6pp to 23.5%. We believe the slower-than-expected improvement in overall gross margin was primarily due to margin pressure in the PCB business.

Maintain Buy; raise TP to CNY39, implying 17.3% upside

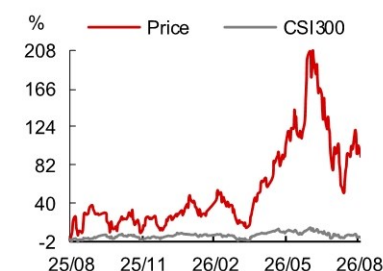
Given stronger-than-expected revenue growth in IC package substrates, we raise our 2026/27F revenue forecasts by 5%/9%. However, reflecting weaker-than-expected margins in the PCB and semiconductor test board businesses, we lower our gross margin forecasts by 1.0pp/1.1pp and cut our net profit forecasts by 10%/23% for the same period. We also introduce our 2028F revenue/net profit forecasts of CNY12.06bn/CNY719mn. We continue to value Fastprint using a P/S-based approach. With the sector valuation benchmark having eroded, the average 2026E P/S of comparable companies has risen to 7.6x from 5.0x previously (based on Wind consensus). Although we expect the company's 2026-28F revenue CAGR to remain below the peer average, its IC package substrate business remains in a high-growth phase and the company has a first-mover advantage in FCBGA substrates. We therefore apply a 7.4x 2026F P/S, at a modest discount to the peer average. Based on our 2026F sales per share of CNY5.2 (CNY5.0 previously), we raise our TP to CNY39 from CNY25, implying 17.3% upside; maintain Buy. The stock currently trades at 6.3x 2026F P/S. **Key catalysts:** faster-than-expected CSP capacity expansion; stronger-than-expected FCBGA volume ramp-up; better-than-expected progress in AI products. **Key downside risks:** raw material price volatility; weaker-than-expected downstream demand; delays in new capacity ramp-up; intensifying industry competition.

Year-end 31 Dec	FY25	FY26F		FY27F		FY28F	
Currency (CNY)	Actual	Old	New	Old	New	Old	New
Revenue (mn)	7,195	8,526	8,919	9,050	9,888		12,061
Reported net profit (mn)	135	388	349	662	512		719
Normalised net profit (mn)	141	388	363	662	512		719
FD normalised EPS	0.08	0.23	0.21	0.39	0.30		0.42
FD norm. EPS growth (%)	—	123.2	157.7	70.6	40.8		40.4
FD normalised P/E (x)	400.7	-	155.5	-	110.4	-	78.6
EV/EBITDA (x)	50.0	-	50.1	-	40.4	-	32.3
Price/book (x)	6.7	-	9.9	-	9.2	-	8.3
Dividend yield (%)	0.1	-	0.1	-	0.1	-	0.1
ROE (%)	2.5	6.7	6.1	10.0	8.3		10.5
Net debt/equity (%)	61.8	39.0	51.2	26.9	51.5		45.1

Source: Wind, company data, Nomura estimates

Rating	Buy
Remains	
Target price	CNY 39.00
Increased from	CNY25.00
Closing price	CNY 33.24
24 Aug 2026	
Implied upside	+17.3%
Market Cap (USD mn)	8,330.8
ADT (USD mn)	861.6

Relative performance chart



Source: Gildata

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Key data on Fastprint

Performance

(%)	1M	3M	12M		
Absolute (CNY)	-1.7	-6.2	91.5	M cap (USDmn)	8,330.8
Absolute (USD)	-1.5	-5.4	101.4	Free float (%)	85.9
Rel to CSI 300	0.2	-0.3	87.2	3-mth ADT (USDmn)	861.6

Source: Gildata

Income statement (CNYmn)

Year-end 31 Dec	FY24	FY25	FY26F	FY27F	FY28F
Revenue	5,817	7,195	8,919	9,888	12,061
Cost of goods sold	-4,894	-5,787	-6,986	-7,586	-9,115
Gross profit	923	1,408	1,933	2,302	2,947
SG&A	-1,244	-1,309	-1,614	-1,808	-2,198
Employee share expense					
Operating profit	-567	-82	197	403	661
EBITDA	295	808	1,213	1,507	1,882
Depreciation	-611	-699	-853	-954	-1,065
Amortisation					
EBIT	-316	109	360	553	817
Net interest expense	-127	-180	-166	-154	-159
Associates & JCEs	0	0	0	0	0
Other income	-128	-5	42	59	68
Earnings before tax	-575	-87	194	399	658
Income tax	44	-17	-19	-20	-33
Net profit after tax	-531	-104	175	379	625
Minority interests	333	239	175	133	94
Other items	0	0	0	0	0
Preferred dividends					
Normalised NPAT	-196	141	363	512	719
Extraordinary items	-3	-6	-14	0	0
Reported NPAT	-198	135	349	512	719
Dividends	-51	-51	-35	-51	-72
Transfer to reserves	-249	84	314	461	647

Valuations and ratios

Reported P/E (x)	-	266.6	161.8	110.4	78.6
Normalised P/E (x)	-	255.2	155.5	110.4	78.6
FD normalised P/E (x)	-	400.7	155.5	110.4	78.6
Dividend yield (%)	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Price/cashflow (x)	150.3	-	35.2	52.9	39.7
Price/book (x)	3.8	6.7	9.9	9.2	8.3
EV/EBITDA (x)	75.4	50.0	50.1	40.4	32.3
EV/EBIT (x)	-	560.5	168.5	110.1	74.4
Gross margin (%)	15.9	19.6	21.7	23.3	24.4
EBITDA margin (%)	5.1	11.2	13.6	15.2	15.6
EBIT margin (%)	-5.4	1.5	4.0	5.6	6.8
Net margin (%)	-3.4	1.9	3.9	5.2	6.0
Effective tax rate (%)	-	-	10.0	5.0	5.0
Dividend payout (%)	-	37.7	10.0	10.0	10.0
ROE (%)	-4.0	2.5	6.1	8.3	10.5
ROA (pretax %)	-2.2	0.8	2.2	3.2	4.5

Growth (%)

Revenue	8.5	23.7	24.0	10.9	22.0
EBITDA	-25.5	173.6	50.2	24.3	24.8
Normalised EPS	-509.9	—	157.7	40.8	40.4
Normalised FDEPS	-509.9	—	157.7	40.8	40.4

Source: Wind, company data, Nomura estimates

Cashflow statement (CNYmn)

Year-end 31 Dec	FY24	FY25	FY26F	FY27F	FY28F
EBITDA	295	808	1,213	1,507	1,882
Change in working capital	-3	-737	384	-414	-410
Other operating cashflow	83	-134	10	-26	-49
Cashflow from operations	376	-63	1,607	1,068	1,422
Capital expenditure	-1,126	-848	-1,036	-1,031	-1,029
Free cashflow	-750	-911	571	36	394
Reduction in investments	-186	19	-21	-13	-18
Net acquisitions	0	0	0	0	0
Dec in other LT assets	0	0	0	0	0
Inc in other LT liabilities	0	0	0	0	0
Adjustments	128	82	-305	26	25
CF after investing acts	-809	-809	245	49	400
Cash dividends	-51	-51	-35	-51	-72
Equity issue	0	0	0	0	0
Debt issue	-281	1,587	479	-100	50
Convertible debt issue					
Others	-312	-508	-58	-184	-183
CF from financial acts	-643	1,028	386	-335	-205
Net cashflow	-1,446	252	614	-286	196
Beginning cash	1,879	433	684	1,298	1,012
Ending cash	433	684	1,298	1,012	1,208
Ending net debt	2,589	3,547	3,033	3,219	3,074

Balance sheet (CNYmn)

As at 31 Dec	FY24	FY25	FY26F	FY27F	FY28F
Cash & equivalents	433	684	1,298	1,012	1,208
Marketable securities	452	479	490	490	490
Accounts receivable	2,149	2,524	3,304	3,595	4,361
Inventories	771	982	1,121	1,233	1,497
Other current assets	579	856	931	915	1,013
Total current assets	4,383	5,526	7,145	7,245	8,570
LT investments	771	912	933	946	965
Fixed assets	6,769	7,016	7,131	7,152	7,068
Goodwill	391	397	452	509	564
Other intangible assets	292	288	314	319	329
Other LT assets	1,062	943	1,240	1,245	1,244
Total assets	13,668	15,082	17,216	17,416	18,738
Short-term debt	152	574	374	274	324
Accounts payable	1,766	1,965	2,711	2,752	3,313
Other current liabilities	1,870	1,577	2,546	2,477	2,636
Total current liabilities	3,788	4,116	5,631	5,504	6,273
Long-term debt	2,869	3,657	3,957	3,957	3,957
Convertible debt					
Other LT liabilities	1,434	1,565	1,700	1,700	1,700
Total liabilities	8,092	9,338	11,288	11,161	11,930
Minority interest	641	395	221	88	-6
Preferred stock					
Common stock	1,690	1,700	1,700	1,700	1,700
Retained earnings	2,300	2,448	2,756	3,217	3,864
Proposed dividends					
Other equity and reserves	946	1,201	1,251	1,251	1,251
Total shareholders' equity	5,576	5,744	5,927	6,255	6,808
Total equity & liabilities	13,668	15,082	17,216	17,416	18,738

Liquidity (x)

Current ratio	1.16	1.34	1.27	1.32	1.37
Interest cover	-2.5	0.6	2.2	3.6	5.1

Leverage

Net debt/EBITDA (x)	8.77	4.39	2.50	2.14	1.63
Net debt/equity (%)	46.4	61.8	51.2	51.5	45.1

Per share

Reported EPS (CNY)	-0.12	0.08	0.21	0.30	0.42
Norm EPS (CNY)	-0.12	0.08	0.21	0.30	0.42
FD norm EPS (CNY)	-0.12	0.08	0.21	0.30	0.42
BVPS (CNY)	2.92	3.15	3.36	3.63	4.01
DPS (CNY)	0.03	0.03	0.02	0.03	0.04

Activity (days)

Days receivable	131.4	116.9	117.6	125.6	118.7
Days inventory	51.6	54.5	54.2	55.9	53.9
Days payable	135.0	116.0	120.5	129.6	119.8
Cash cycle	47.9	55.4	51.4	51.8	52.9

Source: Wind, company data, Nomura estimates

Company profile

Fastprint stands out as one of the few domestic suppliers offering a comprehensive portfolio across packaging substrates, PCBs, and semiconductor test boards. Established as a leader in PCB prototyping and low-volume production, it expanded into the IC packaging substrate market in 2012 - pioneering the domestic sector. Fastprint has built a full-spectrum product suite comprising traditional high-layer count PCBs, rigid-flex boards, high-density interconnect (HDI) boards, substrate-like PCBs (SLPs), ATF semiconductor test boards and packaging substrates (including both CSP and FCBGA).

Valuation Methodology

We derive our target price of CNY39 by applying a 7.4x target P/S to our 2026F sales per share of CNY5.2. Our target multiple represents a modest discount to the average 2026E P/S of comparable companies based on Wind consensus estimates, reflecting our expectation that the company's 2026-28F revenue CAGR will remain below the peer average, partly offset by continued rapid growth in its IC package substrate business and its relatively advanced position in FC-BGA substrates. The stock's benchmark index is the CSI 300 Index.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price

Key downside risks include raw material price volatility; weaker-than-expected downstream demand; delays in the ramp-up of new capacity; and intensifying industry competition.

ESG

According to the company's 2025 ESG Report, carbon emissions per unit of output value declined 11.59% in 2025 versus 2024, exceeding the company's target.

Key charts and tables

Fig. 1: Fastprint – Changes to earnings forecasts

CNYmn	2026F			2027F			2028F
	Old	New	Change	Old	New	Change	New
PCB							
Revenue	5,802	5,577	-4%	6,029	5,972	-1%	6,763
Gross margin	28.5%	26.5%	-2ppt	29.0%	27.5%	-1.5ppt	28.5%
IC Substrate							
Revenue	2,142	2,642	23%	2,351	3,119	33%	4,390
Gross margin	-3.0%	0.0%	3ppt	3.0%	5.0%	2ppt	10.0%
Semiconductor Test Board							
Revenue	300	273	-9%	360	327	-9%	393
Gross margin	39.0%	26.0%	-13ppt	39.0%	32.0%	-7ppt	36.0%
Total revenue	8,526	8,919	5%	9,050	9,888	9%	12,061
y-y %	15%	24%	8.7ppt	6%	11%	4.7ppt	22%
Gross profit	1,932	1,933	0%	2,207	2,302	4%	2,947
Gross margin	22.7%	21.7%	-1ppt	24.4%	23.3%	-1.1ppt	24.4%
Operating expenses	-1,542	-1,614	5%	-1,658	-1,808	9%	-2,198
as % revenue	18.1%	18.1%	0ppt	18.3%	18.3%	0ppt	18.2%
Operating profit	296	197	-34%	513	403	-21%	661
y-y %	123%	341%		73%	105%		64%
Net profit	388	349	-10%	662	512	-23%	719
y-y %	123%	159%		71%	47%		40%

Source: Nomura estimates

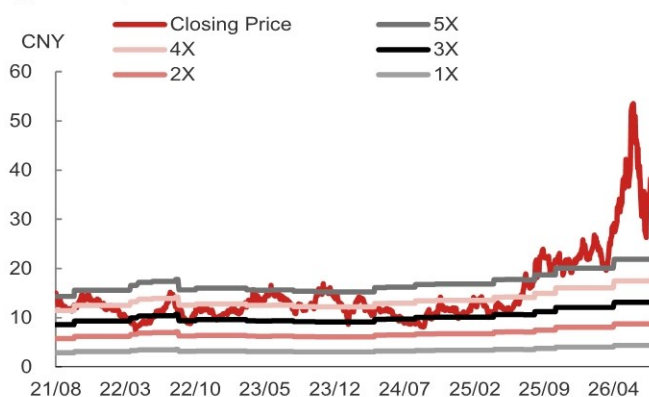
Fig. 2: Fastprint – Valuation comparables

Ticker	Company name	Rating	TP (CNY)	CP (CNY)	Mkt cap (bnCNY)	PS (x)			EPS CAGR	ROE (%)		
						2026F	2027F	2028F		2026F	2027F	2028F
002436 CH	FastPrint	Buy	39.0	33.24	56.5	6.3	5.7	4.7	20%	6.1	8.3	10.5
300814 CH	Jove Enterprise	Not Rated	-	133.00	25.5	9.5	7.0	6.0	31%	8.5	16.7	21.1
603228 CH	Kinwong	Not Rated	-	91.64	91.8	4.8	3.7	3.3	22%	14.8	19.9	23.2
600601 CH	Founder Tech	Not Rated	-	11.54	49.3	8.5	6.8	4.9	30%	20.2	23.0	20.1
Average						7.6	5.9	4.7	28%	14.5	19.9	21.5

Notes: Priced as of 24 Aug 2026; Nomura estimates for rated stocks and Wind consensus estimates for not rated stocks. Among the comparable companies, we replace Sunkat Technology (002815 CH, Not rated), which lacks up-to-date consensus estimates, with Jove Enterprise.

Source: Wind, Nomura estimates

Fig. 3: Fastprint – P/S band



Note: Priced as of 24 Aug 2026.
Source: Wind, Nomura

Fig. 4: Fastprint – P/B band



Note: Priced as of 24 Aug 2026.
Source: Wind, Nomura

Appendix A-1

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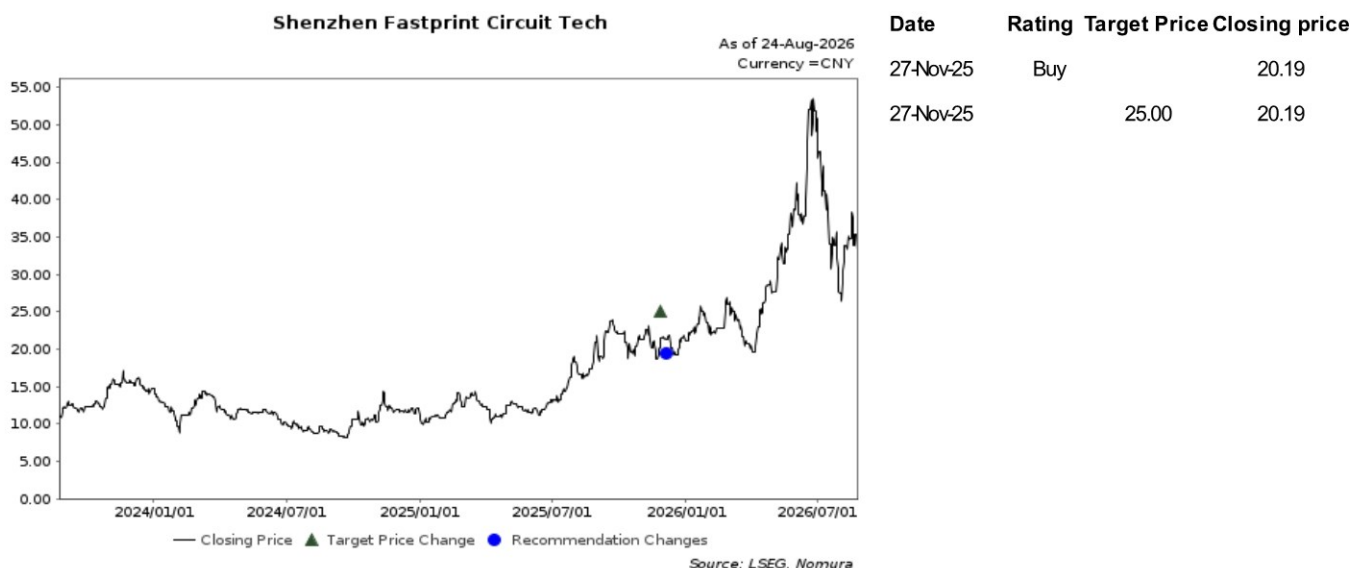
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Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Shenzhen Fastprint Circuit Tech	002436 CH	CNY 33.24	24-Aug-2026	Buy	N/A	

Fastprint (002436 CH)

CNY 33.24 (24-Aug-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

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Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Key downside risks include raw material price volatility; weaker-than-expected downstream demand; delays in the ramp-up of new capacity; and intensifying industry competition.

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As at 30 June 2026.

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